

## Module 0 · Start here

# How to learn French (what the research says)

The study habits that actually move you from beginner to B1 — and the popular ones that don't.

## ● YOU'LL BE ABLE TO

- ✓ Explain why testing yourself beats rereading
- ✓ Plan spaced reviews instead of cramming
- ✓ Balance your week across input, output, study and fluency
- ✓ Set a realistic timeline to B1 / NCLC 5

| When           | What to do                                                  |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Day 1</b>   | Work through the module and pass the check                  |
| <b>Day 2–3</b> | Retake the check and redo the speaking task without looking |
| <b>Day 7</b>   | Drill the related practice set in Type it mode              |
| <b>Day 21</b>  | Re-read only the "Mistakes" section and retake the check    |
| <b>Monthly</b> | Mix it into a weak-item review with other modules           |

| Starting point                        | At 1 hour a day | At 2 hours a day |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|
| <b>True beginner</b>                  | 12–15 months    | 6–8 months       |
| <b>Around A2</b>                      | 5–7 months      | 3–4 months       |
| <b>Around B1, need exam technique</b> | 6–10 weeks      | 4–6 weeks        |

## ● KEY PHRASES

**Pardon, pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ?**  
Sorry, could you repeat that, please?

**Pouvez-vous parler plus lentement ?**  
Could you speak more slowly?

**Je ne comprends pas.**  
I don't understand.

**Qu'est-ce que ça veut dire ?**  
What does that mean?

**Comment dit-on « deadline » en français ?**  
How do you say "deadline" in French?

**Comment ça s'écrit ?**  
How is that spelled?

**J'apprends le français pour immigrer au Canada.**  
I'm learning French to immigrate to Canada.

**Je suis en train d'améliorer mon français.**  
I'm working on improving my French.

## ● AVOID THESE MISTAKES

~~X Rereading notes until they feel familiar~~ ✓ **Covering them and recalling**  
Familiarity is not memory. Recall is what makes it stick (testing effect).

~~X Learning 50 isolated words a day~~ ✓ **Learning 10–15 words inside sentences**  
Words learned in context are easier to recall and use correctly — gender and prepositions come with them.

~~X Finishing one grammar topic before starting the next, forever~~ ✓ **Mixing old topics into every session**  
Interleaving improves retention and the ability to choose the right form.

~~X Waiting until you're "ready" to speak~~ ✓ **Speaking from the first week, even badly**  
Output reveals gaps that reading hides. The exam tests speaking, so train it.

~~X Watching native TV with French subtitles from day one~~ ✓ **Graded input you understand ~95% of**  
Too many unknown words and you stop acquiring and start guessing.

~~X Using only a gamified app~~ ✓ **Using apps as one strand of four**  
Apps are good for vocabulary review, weak for extended output and real listening.

## ● TIP

When you feel stuck, ask which strand you've skipped this week. For most learners, it's output and fluency — they understand far more than they can say.